

Change the shape. Hold the promise.

The real mandate and candidate thesis

ACTUAL MANDATE

Turn a diverse manufacturing footprint into one enterprise system that can scale capacity, improve economics, support NPI and technology transitions, and protect customer commitments without erasing legitimate local technical capability.

WHITE-SPACE THESIS

Standardize the operating contract. Differentiate the technical capability. Define the customer promise, capability map, capacity logic and control system so the network can change shape with evidence.

FOUR LAYERS

- **Promise**
Safety, quality, delivery, reliability, customer recovery and economic non-negotiables.
- **Capability**
Process knowledge, technology, utilities, suppliers, talent and legitimate site differentiation.
- **Capacity**
Demand, bottlenecks, utilization, alternatives, make-buy, capital, timing and resilience.
- **Control**
Decision rights, cadence, escalation, metrics, confidence, learning and leadership bench.

COST OF INACTION

Growth without shared decision architecture can amplify local optimization, capital delay, transfer risk, recurring quality loss, brittle capacity and leadership overload.

The operating tensions

Manage contradictions rather than choosing one side permanently

- **Global standards / local judgment**

Standardize performance language and decisions; preserve process knowledge closest to the work.

- **Delivery now / capacity later**

Protect current commitments while building options for future demand and product transitions.

- **Utilization / resilience**

Use asset economics without making the network brittle.

- **NPI speed / process stability**

Move technology when capability, quality, training and recovery evidence are explicit.

- **Automation / adoption**

Attach digital investments to changed work, human authority, training and results.

- **Enterprise ambition / site capacity**

Sequence change so leaders and teams can absorb it without degrading execution.

DECISION RIGHTS

- Enterprise: portfolio, standards, capital logic and cross-site tradeoffs.
- Site: execution, containment, local process control and daily management.
- Joint: customer risk, capability evidence, transfer readiness, alternatives and closure.

Why Russell's evidence transfers

Direct and adjacent proof without title inflation

- **Advanced electronics manufacturing**

Thirteen years across R&D, production, strategic acquisition, operations and director-level leadership at Compunetics.

- **High-consequence quality**

Engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, root cause, standard work, performance measures and process controls.

- **Distributed customer promise**

Amazon Prime Pittsburgh launch and 24/7 execution supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.

- **Robotics and digital operations**

Current transformation across production, quality, purchasing, support, engineering issue flow, ERP, telemetry and AI-assisted workflows.

- **Regulated autonomous systems**

Drone operations with a verified 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.

- **Technical translation**

Materials science and physical chemistry grounding, industry writing, talks and consortium participation.

STRONGEST CONCERN

Adjacent scale is not identical to verified global VP tenure. Test transferability through operating evidence: map the system, establish trust with site leaders, clarify authority, and prove one consequential cross-site mechanism.

Executive questions and first proof

Surface the real mandate; demonstrate a bounded operating mechanism

QUESTIONS

- Where does the network most often break the customer promise?
- Which site differences are strategic capabilities versus historical variation?
- What capital or footprint decision must be made in the first year?
- How are NPI readiness and technology transfer governed today?
- Which metrics are trusted across every site, and which are debated?
- Where is make-versus-buy logic driven by evidence versus precedent?
- What leadership bench risk would concern the CEO most?
- What must be measurably different twelve months after this hire?

FIRST PROOF

Run one real capacity, NPI, technology-transfer, footprint or make-buy question through the Manufacturing Shape Contract. Define the promise and constraints; map capability; compare capacity, capital, timing and partner options; clarify authority; document assumptions, risks, leading indicators and review date.